

CHAPTER 2 THEORIES OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

SECTION ONE MARXIST THEORIES ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

I. MARXIST THEORETICAL INQUIRY AND KEY PRACTICES CONCERNING INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- (A) The Idea of International Unity
- (B) The Practice of the International Workers' Movement
- (C) Basic Principles of International Unity
- (D) Organizations of International Unity

(A) MARXIST THOUGHT ON INTERNATIONAL UNITY

Proletarian international unity has its objective foundation, inherent necessity, and practical imperative: a shared social position, a common historical mission, and a unified political aspiration.

By the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, world development had entered a new stage marked by novel features: the possibility of worldwide national-liberation movements and the gestation of a social revolution of global significance.

“Workers of all lands, unite!”

(B) MARXIST LEADERSHIP IN THE PRACTICE OF THE INTERNATIONAL WORKERS' MOVEMENT

- Communist League 1847-1852
- International Workingmen's Association (First International) 1864
- Second International 1889-1914
- Third International (Comintern) 1919-1943

(C) BASIC PRINCIPLES OF PROLETARIAN UNITY

- 1. The principle of democratic centralism
- 2. The principle of cooperation and solidarity
- 3. The principle of independent organization
- 4. The principle of equality and voluntariness

(D) PROLETARIAN ORGANIZATIONS OF INTERNATIONAL UNITY

1. The First International powerfully advanced the worldwide movement for proletarian emancipation, leaving an indelible mark on the historical trajectory of united proletarian struggle.
2. The Second International carried out extensive and valuable work in publicizing scientific-socialist ideas, educating and training cadres for the workers' movements of every country, mastering and practicing diverse forms and methods of struggle, and otherwise preparing for socialist revolution—playing a positive and constructive role.
3. The Third International made major contributions to defending Marxism, promoting the international workers' movement and the national-liberation struggles of Asia, Africa, and Latin America, combating fascism and imperialist war, and fostering the development of the international communist movement.

II. NEW DEVELOPMENTS BY THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF CHINA IN MARXIST THEORY ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. The international structure exercises a constraining effect on international organizations and shapes the relationship between states and those organizations.
2. Appraising the status and role of international organizations from the perspective of the themes of the era, China attaches great importance to—and actively supports—the United Nations’ irreplaceable function in building a just and equitable new international order.
3. Starting from the standpoint of the shared destiny of humankind, China has put forward the forward-looking concepts of a “harmonious world” and a “community with a shared future for mankind,” thereby enriching and contributing to the spirit and principles of the United Nations.
4. China has proposed a “Chinese blueprint” for the reform objectives, governance concepts, and basic pathways of the global governance system, emphasizing the need to respect and strengthen the role of the United Nations.

(1) THE INTERNATIONAL STRUCTURE CONSTRAINS INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS AND SHAPES THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN STATES AND INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- In the 1950s, the East–West ideological confrontation kept China excluded from the United Nations and virtually cut off from all global international organizations of the time.
- In the 1960s, Mao Zedong’s theory of “the two intermediate zones” provided theoretical guidance for China’s effort to regain its lawful seat in the United Nations.
- In 1974 Mao Zedong advanced the strategic concept of dividing the world into “three worlds,” and in April 1974 Deng Xiaoping expounded this thesis at the U.N. General Assembly, formally announcing the birth of the “Three Worlds” theory.

(2) VIEWING THE STATUS AND ROLE OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS FROM THE PERSPECTIVE OF THE ERA'S CENTRAL THEME

1. In the 1980s, Deng Xiaoping defined peace and development as the themes of the era, actively affirmed the United Nations' role in international politics, and recognized the normative force of international norms and practices.
2. In the 1990s, Jiang Zemin highlighted the emerging trend toward a multipolar world and the concept of multipolarity, emphasizing and supporting the UN's irreplaceable role in safeguarding world peace, promoting common development, and establishing a just and reasonable new international order.

(3) PROPOSING THE CONCEPTS OF A "HARMONIOUS WORLD" AND A "COMMUNITY WITH A SHARED FUTURE FOR HUMANITY" FROM THE PERSPECTIVE OF HUMAN DESTINY

- On September 15, 2005, during the second plenary meeting of the UN Summit commemorating the 60th anniversary of the founding of the United Nations, Chinese President Hu Jintao delivered a speech entitled "Striving to Build a Harmonious World of Lasting Peace and Common Prosperity," in which he first introduced the concept of a "harmonious world."
- On January 17, 2017, President Xi Jinping delivered a speech entitled "Jointly Building a Community with a Shared Future for Humanity" at the United Nations Office at Geneva, offering a comprehensive exposition of the vision of a community with a shared future for humanity.

(4) PROPOSING CHINA'S APPROACH TO GLOBAL GOVERNANCE

- Reform Objective: Advance the global governance system toward greater fairness and reasonableness, thereby creating favorable conditions for China's development and world peace.
- Governance Philosophy: Promote innovative development of global governance concepts by actively drawing on positive Chinese cultural traditions regarding statecraft and international conduct, identifying their resonance with the needs of our times, further enriching propositions such as building a community with a shared future for humanity, and championing the principle of extensive consultation, joint contribution, and shared benefits in global governance.
- Basic Pathways for Reforming the Global Governance System:
 - Respect and strengthen the role of the United Nations.
 - Reform unjust and unreasonable arrangements within the current global governance system and advance the democratization and rule of law in global governance rules.
 - China supports an international order and system centered on the United Nations and grounded in the purposes and principles of the UN Charter.

SECTION TWO WESTERN IR THEORIES ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

I. REALIST PERSPECTIVES ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- Realism holds that international organizations are merely instruments through which major powers more effectively pursue power politics and advance their own self-interests.
- Classical Realism
- Neorealism

(I) CLASSICAL REALISM ON INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- Classical Realism on International Organizations
- - Edward Carr:
 - The League of Nations is powerless in the face of might;
 - both reason and international morality—the theoretical cornerstones of the League—are flawed.
- - Georg Schwarzenberger:
 - International organizations overstate shared values and the binding force of international law;
 - they are merely bodies of general moral persuasion.

(2) NEOREALISM'S ACCOUNT OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- The establishment and success of international organizations depend on the presence of a hegemonic state possessing overwhelming power resources. International organizations can facilitate international cooperation only under the following condition:
- In the long run, the hegemonic state bears substantial costs of cooperation, which weakens its relative position vis-à-vis other states. Consequently, regardless of how powerful it may be initially, the hegemon will eventually lose its hegemonic status, thereby rendering international organizations ineffective. (And so the US....?)
- (Kenneth Waltz)

II. THE NEOLIBERAL SCHOOL'S ACCOUNT OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

1. Core assumption: In international politics, states' interests are neither mutually exclusive nor entirely identical.
2. International organizations emerge from the convergence of interests and strategic interactions driven by mixed motives.
3. The role of international organizations is to facilitate international cooperation in order to achieve mutual gains.
4. The institutional design of international organizations depends on the nature of the cooperative issue at hand and the authority of national representatives; however, states retain ultimate control over international organizations.
5. The development of international organizations depends not only on the degree of interdependence among member states, but also on the specific ways in which states are interdependent within particular issue areas. (Robert Keohane)

POWER AND INTERDEPENDENCE (ROBERT KEOHANE AND JOSEPH NYE)

International organizations can play significantly diverse and important roles in world politics:

They can identify key issues and help set the international agenda.

They bring together numerous officials, thereby facilitating the formation of potential coalitions in global politics.

They often serve as venues where weaker states can launch political initiatives and pursue linkage strategies. International organizations are often institutional settings particularly suitable for weaker states. They also enable weaker states to implement linkage strategies.

Under conditions of complex interdependence, international organizations will set agendas, catalyze coalition-building, and provide platforms for political action by weaker states.

III. THE CONSTRUCTIVIST SCHOOL'S ACCOUNT OF INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

- Constructivists argue that the establishment of international organizations depends on two key conditions:
- The existence of shared consensus within the international community regarding values and norms.
- Cognitive congruence—i.e., a shared understanding or perception among actors—is crucial for the creation of international organizations.
- Constructivists also contend that non-state norm entrepreneurs, think tanks, and advocacy networks play a pivotal role in the international diffusion of social norms.◦

BARNETT AND FINNEMORE

- 1. View international organizations as bureaucratic institutions.
- Examine the sources and uses of international organizations' autonomy.
- 2. Analyze the power of international organizations and their impact on world affairs.
- 3. Investigate pathological behaviors and institutional change within international organizations.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. - How did Marx, Engels, and Lenin advance the international unity of the proletariat?
2. - How has the Communist Party of China developed a Marxist theory of international organizations?
3. - How does realism assess the role of international organizations?
4. - How does neoliberal international-relations theory explain the emergence of international organizations?
5. - What theoretical contributions has constructivist international-relations theory made to the study of international organizations?